# KC BUSINESS SECURITY BASICS

One page of the ground that actually protects a small business.

Sentinel Safeguard LLC - Kansas City, Missouri - By appointment only - 816-533-8418

### [ ] Change the router password.

The password your router or firewall shipped with is printed in a public manual. Change the admin password to a long, unique passphrase, and note where it is kept.

### [ ] Turn on automatic updates.

Computers, browsers, phones, and the router itself. Attackers now use a published flaw within hours to days - an update waiting a week is a door standing open.

### [ ] Keep backups you have actually restored.

Backups that run on their own, with one copy an attacker in your network cannot reach - and a restore you have tested for real. An unrestored backup is a hope, not a backup.

### [ ] Turn on the second factor everywhere.

Multi-factor authentication on email and banking first, then every account that matters, for every person who uses them. It stops most stolen-password sign-ins cold.

### [ ] Use a password manager and unique passwords.

A different password for every account, kept in a manager. Long passphrases (four or five random words) beat short, clever passwords - and reuse is how one breach becomes every account.

### [ ] Lock screens, lock doors.

Screens that lock themselves after a few idle minutes, and a locked room or closet for the router and network gear. Shared door codes are not a lock.

### [ ] Separate the guest Wi-Fi.

Visitors and personal phones on their own network; the till, the files, and the work machines on another. Most routers can do this in settings today.

### [ ] Know the first call.

Write down, on paper, who you call when a machine behaves like it is not yours - and what not to touch. Ours is 816-533-8418; the report page at sentinelsafeguard.net/report-issue is open around the clock.

Free, in your browser, nothing sent anywhere: the ten-question check at sentinelsafeguard.net/assessment and the practice round at sentinelsafeguard.net/training/phishing. - Sentinel Safeguard LLC